

Rubrics for Serving at a Hierarchical Liturgy

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OCA, Russian recension · Diocese of New York and New Jersey · Filmed 20 June 2026. Times are positions within each clip, so a direction here sits at the same moment in the footage.

HOW TO USE THIS WEBPAGE

Every section below carries the part of the video it describes. Press play and it stops where the section ends, so you can read a direction and watch it without hunting through an hour of footage.

If you would rather watch straight through, or print the whole thing and make your own notes, the links at the top of this page will do it.

Times shown beside each heading are positions within that clip, so they match the moment in the footage rather than the running time of the whole service.

There are also useful appendixes at the end of the document (see the table of contents)

HELP US MAKE THIS BETTER!

This site came out of the 2026 Diocese of NY and NJ Deaconal Retreat. The video was recorded at the retreat, and was edited and annotated by Dn. Mitch VanDuyn, of St. John the Baptist Rochester NY.

Please forgive me for any errors, or omissions, and your corrections and input are most welcome.

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ON SCREEN

Hierarchical Divine Liturgy
Recorded at NY&NJ Deacon Training
20 June 2026

Page references are from St. Tikhon's Hieratikon Vol 2, 2017

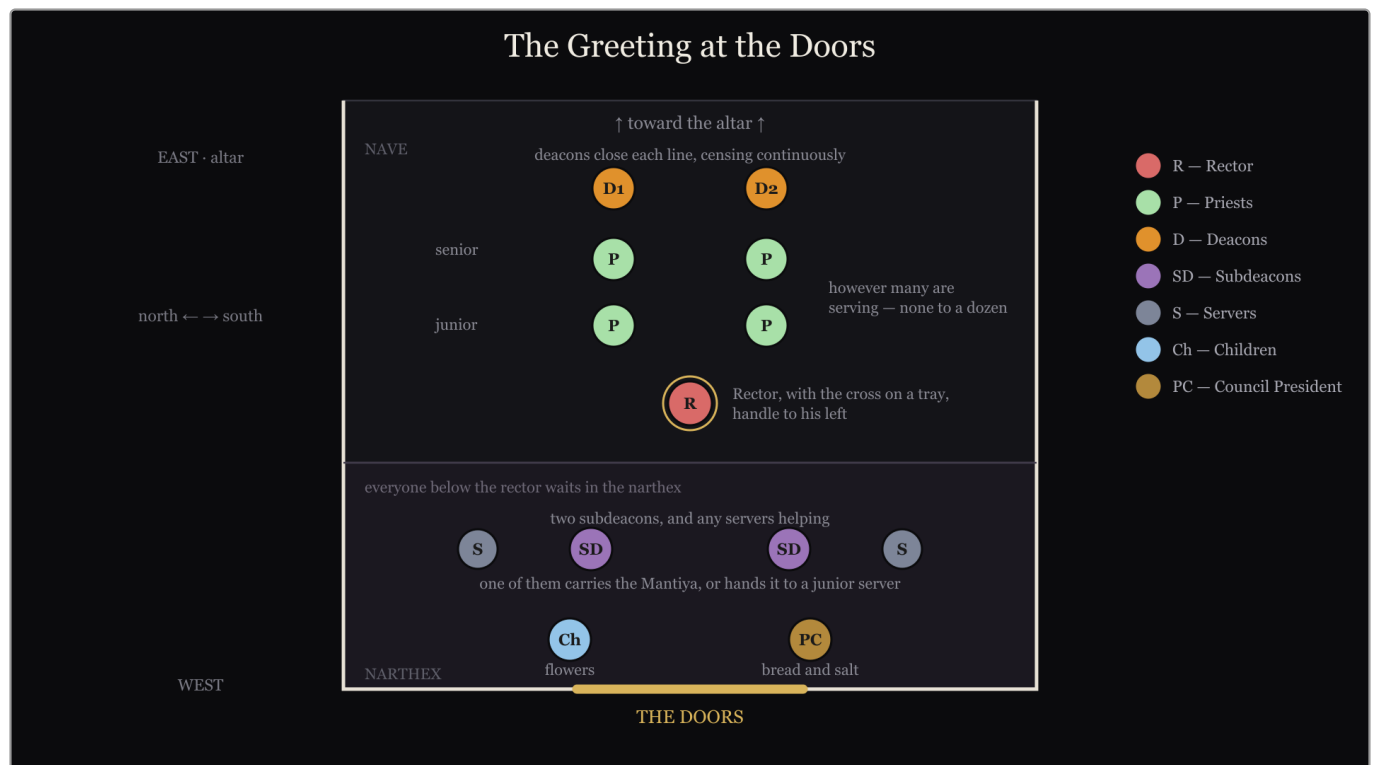
Greeting of the Hierarchy at the Doors

clip 1 · 1:27 · 0:00 in the video

ON SCREEN

Greeting of the Hierarchy at the Doors

Ready at the door should be
Children with flowers.
Parish Council President — bread and salt.



Parish Council President should be prepared with Bread and salt

Children should come with flowers

Priest should be ready with a blessing cross on a tray with handle to the priest's left

Rector at center, other priests to south and north sides of the church

Other priests present should be lined up in order of rank inside the Nave

Deacons should be ready with censers behind the priests

Two vested servers should be ready at the doors with the Mantiya

One subdeacon or altar server holds the train of the Mantiya

Two additional servers should be in the narthex ready to follow and assist

0:06

SUBDEACONS

Subdeacons place the Mantiya

0:10

DEACONS

Continuously cense the Bishop

0:14

Notice arrangement of priests in order of seniority with deacons behind them.

1:22

PRIEST

At the conclusion, the priest presents the cross

The Bishop Enters the Nave

clip 2 · 1:20 · 1:10 in the video

ON SCREEN

The Bishop Greets the Clergy, and Enters the Nave

- 0:01 The priests in order kiss the cross, and the Bishop's hand and receive the blessing,
- 0:09 Then the presiding priest does the same, and is given back the cross on his tray
- 0:16 FIRST DEACON
"Bless, master, the holy incense" - Both Deacons hold up their censers
- 0:27 SECOND DEACON
Wisdom!
- 0:30 DEACONS
turn around and walk forward toward cathedra
- 0:34 CHOIR
While the first deacon, chants and the choir sings - "it is truly meet..."
- 0:42 DEACONS
walk past cathedra, turn around and continue to cense the Bishop
- 0:56 DEACONS, SERVERS
turn towards the altar, as Bishop walks past, giving their censers away
- 1:00 SERVERS
The server holding the train takes the staff, and the Bishop will greet the icons
- 1:04 SERVERS
The two servers holding the censers return them to the altar

Entrance Prayers

clip 3 · 2:44 · 2:35 in the video

ON SCREEN

Entrance Prayers

0:15

FIRST DEACON

reads the entrance prayers quietly,
As normal, BUT stops before "I will enter thy house"

Preparing to Vest the Bishop

clip 4 · 2:10 · 3:13 in the video

ON SCREEN

Preparing to Vest the Bishop

- 1:05

FIRST DEACON

Ton Despôtēn kai Archiaréa hēmōn, Kýrie phýlatte: eis pollà étē, Déspota!
- 1:09

Pronunciation:

ton thes-PO-teen keh ar-hee-eh-REH-ah ee-MON,
KEE-ree-eh FEE-lah-teh: ees poh-LAH EH-tee, THES-poh-tah!
- 1:50

SERVERS

have censers ready at both deacon's doors
- 1:54

DEACONS

retrieve loaded censers from north and south doors

Vesting the Bishop

clip 5 · 1:28 · 4:27 in the video

ON SCREEN

Vesting the Bishop

All vestments, and other articles must have been prepared and neatly stacked.
A tray should be ready to receive the Mantiya and Klobuk. These are ready in the sanctuary or on a table in the nave.
Altar servers need to be assigned to carry these items.
An altar server should be ready to receive the staff, as the senior servers will now help with the vesting.

0:00

SERVERS

A junior server takes the staff, and the Mantiya is removed

0:04

SUBDEACONS

The Bishop takes off his Klobuk and hands to the subdeacons, who place it on the tray.

0:15

SUBDEACONS

The Bishop removes his cross, and Encolpion, and other items

0:19

SERVERS

MEANWHILE: The vestments are brought from their location to the Bishop

0:25

SUBDEACONS

The Bishop removes his riassa, and its placed with the rest of the items

0:33

SERVERS

The items are taken back to the sanctuary

0:36

DEACONS

The deacons raise their censers for the blessing

0:50

DEACONS

Before each item is readied, the second deacon says: Let us pray to the Lord!
Then the first deacon chants the appropriate prayer for that item.

1:05

DEACONS

During the vesting the deacons continuously cense the Bishop.

The Blessing of the Dikiri and Trikiri

clip 6 · 2:10 · 6:15 in the video

ON SCREEN

The Blessing of the Dikiri and Trikiri

As the cross and Encolpion are placed,
the Dikiri and Trikiri are brought from the altar,
followed by the clergy.

0:00

SUBDEACONS

Dikiri on bishops *left* (left is less),
Trikiri on the *right* (more candles, more letters in *right*)

0:46

DEACONS

At the last Amen, rapidly cense the Bishop

1:24

SUBDEACONS

take the Dikiri and Trikiri (kissing the hand) and go to the iconostasis

1:29

DEACONS

as the Bishop blesses the deacons they cense him *nine* times

1:40

SUBDEACONS, DEACONS

The two subdeacons, and deacons turn and reverence the altar,
then turn and reverence the Bishop.

1:49

the subdeacons and servers take the Dikiri, Trikiri and censers to the altar

1:53

DEACONS

while the deacons stand in front and to the side of the Bishop,
bowing first to the altar, then to the Bishop

Final Prayers before the Liturgy

clip 7 · 1:31 · 8:31 in the video

ON SCREEN

Final Prayers before the Liturgy

These are the same prayers said by the priest at the altar,
but here they are said in front of the Ambo
(see pg 87)

0:26

FIRST DEACON

It is time for the Lord to act
etc, just the same as at the beginning of the Liturgy

0:32

FIRST DEACON

pray for me reverend master
and receive the blessing

0:35

SECOND DEACON

also receives a blessing and stands behind the Bishop on his left.

0:38

FIRST DEACON

stands before the icon of Christ at the iconostasis

0:52

FIRST DEACON

along with those at the altar, bow to the high place, then to the Bishop
and the liturgy begins

1:05

SERVERS

The Bishop's Hieratikon is brought out the north door, and the server stands
with the first deacon for the blessing.

1:16

FIRST DEACON

after *unto ages of ages...* turn around and again reverence the Bishop.
note: this is done before each litany by both deacons, remember get a blessing to proceed

Washing of the Hands

clip 8 · 1:17 · 10:10 in the video

ON SCREEN

Washing of the Hands

These are said by the first deacon during the singing of the first antiphon
(see page 71)

The second deacon moves into place for the second (little) litany

0:00

SUBDEACON, SERVERS

As the final litany is chanted *commemorating our most holy...*
Three servers come down in front of the Ambo
Traditionally a young server carries the bowl, pitcher and towel.

0:08

SECOND DEACON

moves forward to stand before the Theotokos

Completion of the Washing of Hands and the Second Litany

clip 9 · 0:30 · 11:36 in the video

ON SCREEN

Completion of the Washing of Hands and the Second Litany

The second deacon is now in place to chant the second litany.
The first deacon moves behind and to the right of the Bishop.
The servers return to the sanctuary

0:00

SERVERS

At the conclusion of the washing of the hands, the servers return to sanctuary

0:04

FIRST DEACON

moves behind and to the right of the Bishop

0:15

SECOND DEACON

As the first antiphon concludes, bow to the icon, and then to the Bishop

The Second Antiphon

clip 10 · 0:21 · 12:16 in the video

ON SCREEN

The Second Antiphon

At the conclusion of each litany the deacon also bows to the Bishop.

As the second antiphon begins, the Hieratikon is brought to the Bishop.

The third Litany is chanted as usual.

The Beginning of the Little Entrance

clip 11 · 1:05 · 12:48 in the video

ON SCREEN

The Beginning of the Little Entrance

The key is to organize the players before leaving the altar

- 1) junior servers with candles: they will end at the back
- 2) then the Dikiri: it will end up at the bishops left
- 3) then a fan: it will be between the Dikiri and the altar
- 4) the **second** and (5) the first deacon: who will travel behind the Bishop
the second deacon crosses over with the censer, between the fan and the altar
the first deacon moves level with the second deacon carrying the Gospel
- 6) then the second fan, which will be level with the other fan
- 7) and finally the Trikiri

0:00

SERVERS

Extra servers carrying candles come first

0:02

SUBDEACON

the **Dikiri**

0:04

SERVERS

the fan on the left

0:06

SECOND DEACON

carrying the censer

0:08

FIRST DEACON

carrying the Gospel

0:11

SERVERS

the fan on the right

0:13

SUBDEACON

the Trikiri

0:16

the Dikiri and fan on the left are dropped off

0:18

every one else moves behind the Bishop and to his right

0:24

notice the censer is carried around to the Bishop's left

0:28 everyone reverences the icons, and then the Bishop

0:39 everyone is now facing each other with the Bishop at the center

The Conclusion of the Little Entrance

clip 12 · 1:40 · 14:08 in the video

ON SCREEN

The Conclusion of the Little Entrance

Generally follows the rubrics on pages 97-99

ON SCREEN

The Dikiri and Trikirī will be taken
from the Bishop as he enters the royal doors.

0:10

FIRST DEACON

Bless Master the Holy Entrance (p 98)

0:16

FIRST DEACON

Presents the Gospel to Bishop to kiss.
Be sure to hold it high enough for the Bishop.

0:21

SUBDEACONS

Hand the Dikiri and Trikirī to the Bishop.
And move just behind the first deacon.
The second deacon continuously censes.
While the fans cover the Gospel.

1:10

DEACONS

with the censer leading, return to the sanctuary

1:22

SUBDEACONS

The senior servers return to escort the Bishop to the Ambo,
and return to the sanctuary, where they wait to take the
Dikiri and Trikirī

Hierarchical Censing After the Great Entrance

clip 14 · 1:54 · 15:54 in the video

ON SCREEN

Hierarchical Censing After the Great Entrance

The Bishop is given the Dikiri (left hand) and censer (right hand.)

The first deacon will *lead* the Bishop in the censing carrying the Trikiri.

The rubrics for the lesser censing are on page 38.

1:43

The first deacon carries the Trikiri to the altar,
and is ready to receive the censer.

A server takes the Dikiri, while the first deacon takes the censer.

Troparion, Kontakion, Save the Pious and the Thrice Holy

clip 15 · 3:58 · 18:01 in the video

ON SCREEN

Troparion, Kontakion, Save the Pious and the Thrice Holy

This follows the exact rubrics from page 101, including the first deacon's proclamation of *O Lord, save the pious* which is often not said in parish practice.

0:00 Ignore the many observing deacons

0:04 **SUBDEACONS**
Dikiri on the **right**, Trikiri on the **left**.
So that they are the bishops left and right hand as he faces the people.

0:31 **FIRST DEACON**
As the choir sings *to ages of ages...*
goes to the high place bows to the high place and the Bishop. *This is the normal practice and should always be done before any action by the deacon*

0:44 **SUBDEACONS**
Note the position of Trikiri and Dikiri

0:50 **FIRST DEACON**
Get the blessing from the Bishop and stand in front of Christ.

1:13 **FIRST DEACON**
Let us pray to the Lord etc, following the full rubric on page 101

1:27 **FIRST DEACON**
O Lord, save the pious is often translated in modern use as *O Lord, save those who fear thee*

2:00 **FIRST DEACON**
After smoothly walking through the royal doors, go to the high place as usual, **and take the DIKIRI** to the Bishop

Conclusion of Thrice Holy

clip 16 · 1:17 · 22:10 in the video

ON SCREEN

Conclusion of the Thrice Holy

Rubrics are the same as page 102-103

Second deacon will read the epistle

1:05

SECOND DEACON

gets the blessing from the Bishop, and walks out the **royal doors** holding the epistle book high with the cross facing the people.

Lesser Censing, and Epistle Reading

clip 17 · 3:17 · 23:08 in the video

ON SCREEN

Lesser Censing, and Epistle Reading

0:00

SERVERS

bring the censer opened fully, and spoon of incense.
Hand the censer to the first deacon and spoon to the Bishop.
The first deacon will hold the censer and the Bishop will add the incense.

0:32

FIRST DEACON

Let us attend!, etc... per the normal liturgy, followed by the lesser censing.

1:00

SUBDEACONS

remove the Omophoron, and hand it to a server who will stand to the side holding with the cross at the center

1:42

FIRST DEACON

in best practice will finish censing the sanctuary and the doors and will wait at the royal doors till he announces the epistle before censing the iconostasis.

2:18

FIRST DEACON

after censing the iconostasis, returns to cense the clergy as is normal, remembering to first cense the Bishop 9 times, then clergy from senior to junior, and south to north.

2:38

FIRST DEACON

then censes the reader, the choir and the people as is normal.

3:00

FIRST DEACON

finally censes Christ, Mary, and the altar as normal, and the Bishop (but only three times), bows to the high place, and the Bishop, and gives away the censer.

Alleluias and the Gospel Book Goes Out

clip 18 • 0:52 • 26:32 in the video

ON SCREEN

Alleluias and the Gospel Book Goes Out

0:00

SERVERS

Altar servers use both doors,
candle bearers first,
then fans,
then Dikiri and Trikiriri.

0:36

SERVERS

go out both doors, and wait at the Ambo
for the Gospel

0:48

FIRST DEACON

walk out the doors, as the Alleluias finish.
Two deacons should cross beside each other.

Reading of the Gospel

clip 19 · 1:04 · 27:30 in the video

ON SCREEN

Reading of the Gospel

0:00

SECOND DEACON

enters through the royal doors after reading the epistle, and stands on the south side of the altar holding the epistle book up, as the Gospel is announced.

0:12

SECOND DEACON

Wisdom let us attend, let us listen to the Holy Gospel!

0:48

SECOND DEACON

Let us attend!

0:52

SECOND DEACON

Kiss the altar, and then get a blessing from the Bishop, returning to his place at the altar.

1:00

SERVER

presents Omophoron to the Bishop to kiss.

Gospel is Returned to the Altar

clip 20 · 0:28 · 28:41 in the video

ON SCREEN

Gospel is Returned to the altar

- 0:04

SUBDEACONS

upon returning to the Ambo hands the Trikiri and Dikiri to the Bishop, and waits for him to complete the blessing, then return them to the altar
- 0:14

FIRST DEACON

unfolds the Eliton
- 0:20

FIRST DEACON

unfolds the left and right sides of the Antimension, and kisses the altar

Augmented Litany Begins

clip 21 · 0:22 · 29:15 in the video

ON SCREEN

The Second deacon Begins The Augmented Litany
after the Sermon as usual

Augmented Litany through censings before great entrance

clip 22 · 7:10 · 29:36 in the video

ON SCREEN

Augmented Litany through Censing before Great Entrance

There are several important differences,
so watch carefully.

0:06

SUBDEACON

during the augmented litany,
uncovers the gifts in preparation for the Bishop's
commemorations. Note the placement of the various
cloths, and utensils.

2:09

DEACONS

perform the full rubrics for dismissing the catechumens.
(pg 113)

2:30

FIRST DEACON

censes the sanctuary - altar, table of oblation, high place,
the icons, Bishop (9x), the clergy and servers, then stops.

4:12

SERVERS

bring out the pitcher of water, with a server having a towel
on his shoulders, carrying the bowl.

4:22

SUBDEACONS

prepare to hold the Omophoron above the Bishop during the
washing of the hands.

Be sure the buttons are facing the Royal Doors

4:38

SUBDEACONS

raise the Omophoron after the Bishop has passed through the
Royal Doors

4:46

note: in some traditions the Bishop will sprinkle the water
towards the congregation. Wait a few seconds before
presenting the towel.

5:08

SUBDEACONS

reattach the Omophoron.

5:24

DEACONS

follow the rubrics on pg 118 as normal:
That we may receive the King of all... X 3

6:02

SERVER

takes the Bishop's Miter.

6:15

DEACONS

proceed to the table of oblation,
the second deacon carrying a censer.

6:20

SECOND DEACON

hands the censer to the Bishop,
kissing His hand.

6:31

SECOND DEACON

receives the censer back from the Bishop,
kneels, and receives the Aer on his shoulder,
and the censers the doors, the iconostasis,
and the people.

Clergy Kissing the Bishops Shoulder

clip 23 · 0:09 · 36:24 in the video

ON SCREEN

Clergy Kissing the Bishops Shoulder

In order of rank the clergy and the servers state their rank and name, and kiss the Bishop's shoulder.

The Bishop makes His Commemorations

clip 25 · 0:09 · 36:40 in the video

ON SCREEN

The Bishop now makes His Commemorations

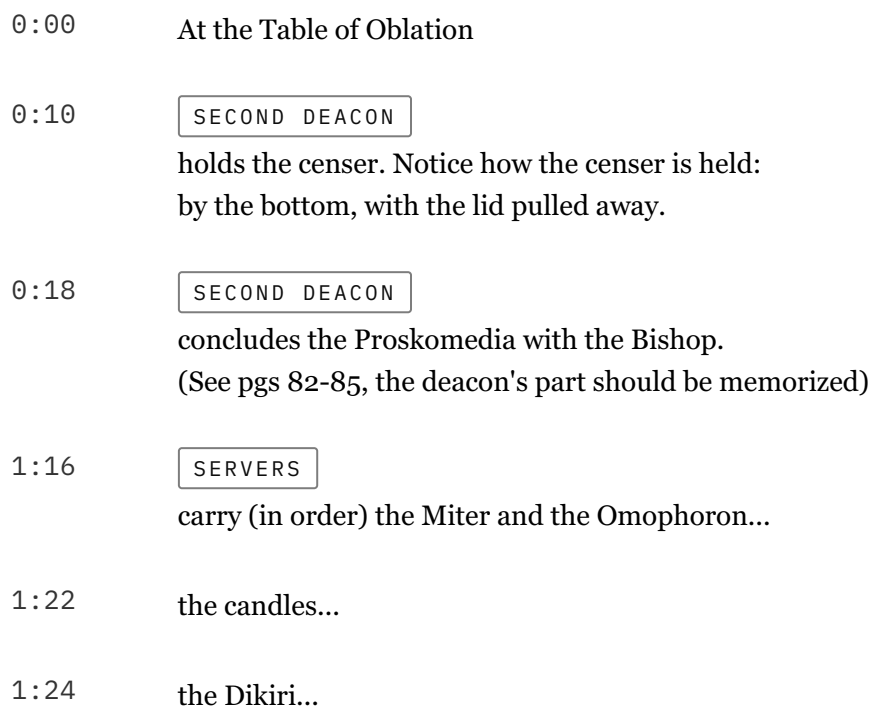
0:00

SECOND DEACON

remains at the Table of Oblation ready to
complete the Proskomedie with the Bishop.

clip 26 · 4:31 · 36:55 in the video

Covering the Gifts and The Great Entrance



1:26 the censer (carried by the second deacon)...

1:28 a fan...

1:33 the Diskos (carried by the first deacon)...

1:36 the Chalice...

1:38 the second fan, and Trikiriri...

1:43 and other priests carrying crosses.

1:47 SERVERS

have continued moving through the south deacon's doors,
carrying the Omophoron and Miter

1:53 SECOND DEACON

also has returned to the sanctuary through the Royal Doors
and is at his side of the altar, with his censer.

2:00 meanwhile on the Ambo the procession proceeds so that:
fans are on either side of the Royal doors,
Dikiri and Trikiriri behind them (or if Ambo is narrow beside them)
the first deacon and priest carrying the gifts at the foot of the Ambo,
other priests behind them,
and candle bearers behind them.

This will set things up for the following actions

2:31 SECOND DEACON

gives the censer to the Bishop.

2:36 FIRST DEACON

moves the center of the royal doors, and kneels presenting the
Diskos to the Bishop, who censes him.

2:46 DEACONS

The second deacon takes the censer and the first deacon hands
the Diskos to the Bishop.

The first deacon returns to the altar, either through the royal
doors (if there is room) or through the south deacon's door.

3:23 The priest carrying the chalice has presented it to the Bishop and again the second deacon will hand the censer to the Bishop and take it back.

3:41 SECOND DEACON
now moves to the other side of the altar still holding the censer, and wearing the aer.

3:51 SUBDEACONS
after the Bishop finishes blessing with the Dikiri and Trikirī and returns to the altar, the subdeacons cross the Ambo swapping places.

This allows the Dikiri and Trikirī to return to the correct side of the altar.

4:05 The following is a diagram of the where everyone should stand outside the sanctuary during the Great Entrance.

Conclusion of the Great Entrance

clip 27 · 0:30 · 41:13 in the video

ON SCREEN

Conclusion of the Great Entrance

Not shown: The second deacon kneels to the Bishop and the Aer is removed. He rises and holds the censer as the Aer is censed, then the censer is given to the Bishop.

0:00

SECOND DEACON

takes the censer back from the Bishop, goes the high place, censes the Bishop 9 times, then bows to the high place.

0:15

SUBDEACONS

have remained on the Ambo and will hand the Dikiri and Trikirion to the Bishop, and then after the blessing return them to the Altar.

Litany of Supplication and the Creed

clip 28 · 2:41 · 41:59 in the video

ON SCREEN

Litany of Supplication and the Creed

For the Deacons and servers this follows
the normal rubrics.

The anaphora part 1

clip 29 · 2:55 · 42:30 in the video

ON SCREEN

The anaphora part 1

0:00

SUBDEACONS

have brought the Trikiri and Dikiri to the corner of the altar during the creed...

0:06

and hand them to the Bishop as the creed concludes.

0:34

the first deacon returns to the sanctuary, and the subdeacons and deacons now stand together, at the high place

1:18

SUBDEACONS

move back to be ready to receive the Trikiri and Dikiri as the choir sings *It is meet and right...* (pg 129)

1:30

All will bow to the high place together, turn, and then the Dikiri and Trikiri are returned to their places

1:42

SUBDEACONS

return to their places. The second deacon will kiss the altar and hold the star as usual.

The anaphora part 2

clip 30 · 1:36 · 44:51 in the video

ON SCREEN

The anaphora part 2: Words of Institution

This follows the exact rubrics on pg 132,
the first deacon raising the chalice.

The anaphora part 3

clip 31 · 1:04 · 46:33 in the video

ON SCREEN

The anaphora part 3: Epiclesis

Again this follows the exact rubrics on pg 134-135.

0:04

FIRST DEACON

Create in me a clean heart oh God, and renew a right Spirit within me!

0:14

SECOND DEACON

Cast me not away from thy presence, and take not thy Holy Spirit from me!

0:42

FIRST DEACON

Bless Master the Holy Bread...Bless Master the Holy Cup...etc
(all said by the first deacon pg 134)

The anaphora part 4

clip 32 · 2:44 · 47:42 in the video

ON SCREEN

The anaphora part 4

With the Bishop present additional prayers are said
by the first deacon before the Lord's prayer.
These are not in the rubrics book!

0:16

SECOND DEACON

takes the censer from the Bishop and continues to bless the south, east, north, and west sides of the altar, and returning to the south-east corner, censes the Bishop 3 times.

0:48

FIRST DEACON

while the hymn is being sung, goes to the high place, makes the usual reverences, and kissing the altar as he passes, goes out through the Royal doors.

0:56

CHOIR

singing... *without corruption thou gavest birth to God the Word: true Theotokos, we magnify thee.*

1:07

FIRST DEACON

now says: *For All Mankind!*

1:38

The following prayer and action begins as the priest concludes with the words *Among the first ... and rightly divides the word of thy truth!*

1:58

FIRST DEACON

For His Eminence, The Most Reverend Michael, Archbishop of New York, of the Diocese of New York, and New Jersey...

2:06

FIRST DEACON

who here offers -- and turning enters the sanctuary --
These Holy Gifts -- pointing to the Diskos and Chalice

2:09

FIRST DEACON

Unto the Lord our God -- after going to the high place and reverencing the high place and the Bishop

- 2:12 FIRST DEACON
*For the most blessed Tikhon, Archbishop of Washington
Metropolitan of all America and Canada*
- 2:18 FIRST DEACON
*For the holy synod of Bishops, the Most Reverend Metropolitans,
Archbishops and Bishops*
- 2:25 FIRST DEACON
For the honorable priesthood the diaconate in Christ
- 2:29 FIRST DEACON
Goes and stands again under the arch of the Royal doors, while saying:
For every priestly and monastic order.
- 2:35 FIRST DEACON
For this land, its civil authorities and armed forces.
- 2:42 FIRST DEACON
*For peace of the whole world
For the good estate of God's Holy Churches*
- 0:00 FIRST DEACON
*For the salvation and assistance of all those
who diligently labor and serve*
- 0:08 FIRST DEACON
*For the healing of the sick, for the repose, pardon,
blessed memory, and forgiveness of sins of all
Orthodox who have fallen asleep.*
- 0:20 FIRST DEACON
*For the salvation of all the people here present, and
for those they have in mind.*
- 0:28 FIRST DEACON
And for all mankind!
- 0:35 FIRST DEACON
Returns to the high place, makes the usual reverences,
and receives a blessing from the Bishop, kissing His
hand and shoulder.

1:00

SECOND DEACON

Goes out the south door, to give the litany before the
Lords Prayer in the usual fashion (pgs 140-143)

After Communion

clip 34 · 1:22 · 51:51 in the video

ON SCREEN

Holy Communion now proceeds in the usual fashion.

The clergy in order of rank receive the body,
from the Bishop, stating their rank and name,
and kissing the Bishops hand and shoulder.

And again receiving the precious blood in the
usual manner.

ON SCREEN

The video continues after the clergy and faithful
have received communion.

Litany of Thanksgiving

clip 35 · 1:17 · 53:30 in the video

ON SCREEN

Litany of Thanksgiving

Final blessing and Many Years

clip 36 · 4:07 · 54:53 in the video

ON SCREEN

Final blessing and Many Years

Conclusion

clip 37 · 0:21 · 59:06 in the video

ON SCREEN

Conclusion

Glossary

appendix A

Dikirion — the two-branched candlestick, signifying the two natures of Christ. **Trikirion** — the three-branched candlestick, signifying the Trinity.

Zhezl — the bishop's staff. Written *jezel* in some of the notes; the same object is called simply "the staff" elsewhere, and one spelling should win before this is published.

Orlets — the eagle rug the bishop stands on.

Assigning The Roles

appendix B

The rubrics above call on subdeacons throughout. You may have to appoint one or even two subdeacons choosing adult, experienced altar servers for the role. They should be vested and know the whole sequence beforehand — this is not a role to hand to someone on the day. Another option is to have deacons act as subdeacons.

Another important role, is the altar server who will bring out the bowl, pitcher and towel for the washing of the Bishops hands. Usually this is a junior server who will be greatly encouraged by playing this important role.

Having two more adult servers who will keep an eye on things on the north and south sides of the altar is a good idea. They should watch the subdeacons for direction, and can be a great help in keeping things running smoothly by paying attention.

Additional altar servers can carry lamps in the entrances, and should be behind the other clergy and servers. See the little and great entrances for details. Also try to line the servers up symmetrically if possible: for example if you have two smaller boys carrying lamps and one larger boy, the larger boy should be in the middle.

The role of Altar servers

appendix C

The following analogy may be useful in helping younger boys to stay focused and on task:

Christians, and especially Orthodox Christians are like God's special forces. We are in the world taking back territory that has been stolen by the evil one.

The temple in which we meet is like a protected forward fort in enemy territory. When we are in the temple, we are in a safe place, with more protection from evil than in the outside world. We come to the temple to be healed from our wounds, to rest, and to be trained for the next battle.

But at any fort you will always have guards, and that is precisely what the altar servers are. And the more alert and focused the servers on their duty no matter how small it may seem, the harder time the enemy will have in attacking our fort.

Serving with More or Less than Two Deacons

appendix D

The rubrics throughout assume two deacons, which is the normal case at a hierarchical liturgy. Where fewer are available the duties do not disappear; they are reassigned.

With one deacon, he takes the first deacon's part throughout, and the litanies that would alternate fall to him.

Where there are no subdeacons, two senior altar servers should be appointed to their duties, though they do not vest as subdeacons and do not handle the dikirion and trikirion at the blessing.

Where there are more than two deacons, the third and fourth deacons have take some of the roles of the second deacon as well.

TBD: the excellent pocket sized deacons role chart here.